INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Professional Development

PRINCIPLES OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT & ADMINISTRATION

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.
2. Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.
3. Explain the need for innovation skills.
4. Identify ways that technology impacts business.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of an office assistant at HARMON & REYES INSURANCE AGENCY, a local insurance agency with 25 employees. A longtime employee (judge) is worried about upcoming changes and has asked to talk with you.

The agency is switching to new software next month. The software uses artificial intelligence (AI) to schedule appointments, draft emails to clients and organize policy documents. The longtime employee (judge) has worked at the agency for 22 years and is very good with clients but is nervous about technology. The employee (judge) has heard rumors that the software will "replace people" and is thinking about retiring early instead of learning a new system. The agency will pay for online training courses and has offered a lunch-and-learn session each Friday.

The employee (judge) wants you to explain why workers need to keep learning, what resources are available, why innovation skills matter and how technology is changing businesses like the agency.

You will present the information to the employee (judge) in the employee's (judge's) office. The employee (judge) will begin the conversation by greeting you and sharing their concerns. After you have presented the information and answered the employee's (judge's) questions, the employee (judge) will conclude the conversation by thanking you for your help.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Besides the company training, where else can I go to build my skills?
2. What if I try the training and still don't understand the software?

Rate the participant's ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the need for ongoing education as a worker.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
2.	Utilize resources that can contribute to professional development.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
3.	Explain the need for innovation skills.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
4.	Identify ways that technology impacts business.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9-10-11	12	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
					TOTAL SCORE	